

ShieldAI

The Virtual CISO Platform

• LIVE IN PRODUCTION • Executive Summary • Confidential • 2026

“A full-time CISO costs \$200,000–\$400,000 a year. Nearly half of small businesses have no security budget at all — yet their insurers, customers, and regulators now require a real security program. ShieldAI closes that gap — and it’s already live.”

ShieldAI is a live, in-production virtual Chief Information Security Officer (vCISO) platform for small and mid-sized businesses. It is not a concept, a prototype, or a set of mockups — it is deployed, and anyone can create an account and use it today. A visitor can register, run a real security assessment, choose a NIST, CIS, or blended scoring foundation, receive a deterministic risk score, and generate written policies and a prioritized remediation roadmap in minutes.

The platform delivers a complete, continuously-managed security program — deterministic risk scoring, written policies, a prioritized roadmap, multi-framework compliance mapping, real threat intelligence, security-awareness training, and executive reporting — at a price a small business can actually afford. Behind it runs a production stack: a multi-provider AI layer (Claude primary, with Gemini and GPT), a tiered advisor scoped to each customer’s plan, live CVE and breach-exposure intelligence, cross-platform read-only monitoring agents, a standalone training product, and a live analyst console with strict client isolation.

Strategy: Wedge to Platform

Our strategy is a deliberate wedge-to-platform progression. We begin with the affordable, largely self-serve product that is live today and delivers immediate value — including a free assessment tier that turns curiosity into a qualified lead. As we grow, we layer human expertise on top: cybersecurity engineers who use ShieldAI’s live analyst console to run full, managed CISO programs for a portfolio of clients — with the software and its read-only AI co-pilot doing the heavy lifting so a small team can protect a large book of businesses. This is how we move from a low-cost tool to a high-value managed-security platform without a linear increase in headcount.

Where the Moat Actually Is

ShieldAI is powered by frontier AI for analysis and content generation, but our defensibility does not rest on the AI itself. It rests on three things: a proprietary, deterministic security-scoring engine built on the NIST Cybersecurity Framework (with a control-mapped CIS v8.1 alternate) that produces explainable, auditor- and insurer-trustworthy results; a human-in-the-loop model in which qualified engineers review and approve work before it reaches the client; and the proprietary assessment data and client relationships that compound over time. Two boundaries are deliberate and are a selling point: the AI co-pilot is read-only and advisory, and analysts are strictly isolated to their assigned clients. The AI is a commodity input — the scoring system, the human review layer, and the accumulating data are the moat.

Pricing & Unit Economics

A five-tier ladder is built for land-and-expand: Free → Starter \$159 → Growth \$349 → Guided \$699 → Managed vCISO \$1,950/month. Training reinforces the upgrade motion: Starter includes the AI-recommended training plan, and the full employee training delivery product is a \$40/month add-on at Starter and bundled free from Growth up. The economics are measured, not estimated: AI cost is roughly \$0.28 per client per month, one engineer manages about 25 managed clients through the console, and gross margin runs ~75% at the managed tier and ~60% blended across all tiers. Revenue scales with the client book while engineer headcount grows far more slowly; churn, not price or AI cost, is the binding constraint — and the managed tier plus continuous monitoring are designed to defend it.

Key Highlights

Status	LIVE IN PRODUCTION — deployed and usable today at shieldai-production-627e.up.railway.app
Target market	U.S. SMBs with employees, prioritizing regulated and insured segments
Core category	Virtual CISO (vCISO) — ~\$2B+ today, growing 12–15%+ annually
Demand driver	Cyber-insurance, customer security requirements, and regulation forcing SMBs to act
Model	Wedge: low-cost self-serve → Expand: engineer-run managed vCISO programs
Differentiation	Deterministic NIST + CIS scoring engine, human-in-the-loop, real verifiable data, live analyst platform
Built & working	Assessment & deterministic scoring, AI program & policy generation, multi-framework compliance, tiered Mastermind advisor, live CVE/breach intel, read-only monitoring agents, standalone training delivery product (\$40/mo Starter add-on; bundled Growth+), live analyst console with client isolation, accounts, admin
Staged for GA	Stripe billing (integrated; dev/admin tier-switchers bypass it for demos today)
Next milestone	Scale the managed book — go-to-market, first paying managed clients, and first security-engineer hires

Most companies at our stage are pitching a plan. We are pitching a product that already exists and works — the full platform, including the managed-services analyst console, is built, deployed, and functioning. **This raise funds the go-to-market and first engineer hires that scale a working product into a managed-security business — and lets a handful of our engineers protect thousands of small businesses.**

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